UNIT 12.2 · LEVEL A2

Permission – can / can't / could / couldn't

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 _____ I use your phone, please?

a) Do **b)** Are **c)** Can **d)** Must

2 You _____ take photos in the museum. It's forbidden.

a) can't **b)** can **c)** could **d)** must

3 In my old school, we _____ wear jeans. It was against the rules.

a) can't **b)** can **c)** could **d)** couldn't

4 _____ I sit here? — Yes, of course you can.

a) Does **b)** Could **c)** Are **d)** Did

5 Children _____ watch TV after 9 p.m. in my house. It's not allowed.

a) can **b)** can't **c)** could **d)** couldn't

6 Which sentence is correct?

a) Can I to go out? **b)** Can I goes out? **c)** Do I can go out? **d)** Can I go out?

7 When I was ten, I _____ stay up late on Fridays. My parents allowed it.

a) could **b)** couldn't **c)** can't **d)** can

8 _____ we eat in the classroom? — No, you can't.

a) Do **b)** Are **c)** Can **d)** Must

9 Can I borrow your pen? — Yes, you _____.

a) do **b)** are **c)** could **d)** can

10 He _____ drive when he was 15. It was illegal.

a) couldn't **b)** can't **c)** can **d)** could

Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 _____ I open the window? It's hot.

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12 You _____ smoke here. It's not allowed.

13 _____ I use the bathroom, please?

14 In the past, women _____ vote in many countries. It wasn't allowed.

15 You _____ park here. There's no sign.

16 Can I take a photo? — Yes, you _____.

17 Can I use your phone? — No, I'm sorry, you _____.

18 When I was a child, I _____ watch TV only on weekends.

19 We _____ wear shoes in the temple. It was forbidden.

20 _____ I sit here? — Yes, of course.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **you / can't / park / here**

_____

22 **where / can / I / park**

_____

23 **we / couldn't / wear / jeans / at / school**

_____

24 **children / can't / play / here**

_____

25 **what / can / I / eat / here**

_____

26 **they / couldn't / use / phones / in / class**

_____

27 **when / can / we / go / home**

_____

28 **you / can't / take / photos / here**

_____

Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the correct word.*
_____ I use your phone, please?
Options: **Can** / **Do** / **Are**

30 *Choose the correct form.*
You _____ smoke here. It's forbidden.
Options: **can't** / **can** / **could**

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31 *Choose the correct form.*
We _____ wear jeans at my old school. It was against the rules.
Options: **couldn't** / **can't** / **can**

32 *Choose the correct form.*
In my house, children _____ watch TV after nine.
Options: **can't** / **can** / **could**

33 *Choose the correct word.*
Can I use your pen? — Yes, you _____
Options: **can** / **do** / **are**

34 *Choose the correct form.*
When I was ten, I _____ stay up late on Fridays.
Options: **could** / **can't** / **couldn't**

35 *Choose the correct word.*
Could I open the window? — No, I'm sorry, you _____
Options: **can't** / **don't** / **aren't**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each sign to its meaning.

1. No smoking _____
2. No photos _____
3. Free Wi-Fi _____
4. No entry _____
5. Open to the public _____

A. You can't take photos.
B. You can't smoke here.
C. You can't go in.
D. You can come in.
E. You can use the internet.

37 Match each question to a reply.

1. Can I use your phone? _____
2. Can I park here? _____
3. Could I open the window? _____
4. Could I sit here? _____

A. Sorry, it's taken.
B. Yes, you can.
C. No, you can't.
D. Yes, of course.

38 Match each present sentence to its past form.

1. You can't wear jeans. _____
2. You can use phones. _____
3. Students can't talk. _____
4. We can go out. _____

A. We could go out.
B. Students couldn't talk.
C. You could use phones.
D. You couldn't wear jeans.

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39 Match each place to a rule.

1. In a library _____
2. In a park _____
3. In a hospital _____
4. In a restaurant _____
5. In a museum _____

A. You can ask for the menu.
B. You can't talk loudly.
C. You can't touch the paintings.
D. You can't smoke.
E. You can walk on the grass.

40 Match each question to the answer.

1. Where can I park? _____
2. What can I eat here? _____
3. When can we go home? _____
4. Who can I ask? _____
5. How can I pay? _____

A. Ask the manager.
B. By card or cash.
C. Anything on the menu.
D. At five o'clock.
E. Behind the building.

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 Can I uses your phone? Correct word: _____

42 You can't parks here. Correct word: _____

43 Could I opens the window? Correct word: _____

44 We couldn't wore jeans at school. Correct word: _____

45 She can goes out tonight. Correct word: _____

46 Children can't plays here. Correct word: _____

47 Do I can sit here? Correct word: _____

48 Yesterday I can't go out. Correct word: _____

49 In 1950, women can't vote in many countries.
Correct word: _____

50 Cans I take a photo? Correct word: _____

Your score

Count one point for each correct answer. Below 70%? Review the topic and try the unit again in a few days.

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

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UNIT 12.2 · LEVEL A2

Answer Key

Permission – can / can’t / could / couldn’t

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** Can	'Can I...?' asks for permission.
2	**a)** can't	'Can't' says something isn't allowed.
3	**d)** couldn't	'Couldn't' is the past of 'can't'.
4	**b)** Could	'Could I...?' asks for permission politely.
5	**b)** can't	'Can't' says something isn't allowed.
6	**d)** Can I go out?	Can + subject + base verb.
7	**a)** could	'Could' is the past of 'can' for permission.
8	**c)** Can	'Can we...?' asks for permission.
9	**d)** can	Short answer: Yes, you can.
10	**a)** couldn't	'Couldn't' is the past of 'can't'.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**Can** (or: Could)	'Can I...?' asks for permission.
12	**can't** (or: cannot)	'Can't' says something isn't allowed.
13	**Could** (or: Can)	'Could I...?' asks for permission politely.
14	**couldn't**	'Couldn't' is the past of 'can't'.
15	**can**	'Can' says something is allowed.
16	**can**	Short answer: Yes, you can.
17	**can't** (or: cannot)	Short answer: No, you can't.
18	**could**	'Could' is the past of 'can' for permission.
19	**couldn't**	'Couldn't' is the past of 'can't'.
20	**Can** (or: Could)	'Can I...?' asks for permission.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**You can't park here.**	Order: subject + can't + base verb + place.
22	**Where can I park?**	Order: Where + can + subject + base verb.
23	**We couldn't wear jeans at school.**	Order: subject + couldn't + base verb + object + place.
24	**Children can't play here.**	Order: subject + can't + base verb + place.
25	**What can I eat here?**	Order: What + can + subject + base verb + place.
26	**They couldn't use phones in class.**	Order: subject + couldn't + base verb + object + place.
27	**When can we go home?**	Order: When + can + subject + base verb.
28	**You can't take photos here.**	Order: subject + can't + base verb + object + place.

Part D · Choose and Complete

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29	**Can**	'Can I...?' asks for permission.
30	**can't**	'Can't' says something isn't allowed.
31	**couldn't**	'Couldn't' is the past of 'can't'.
32	**can't**	'Can't' says something isn't allowed.
33	**can**	Short answer: Yes, you can.
34	**could**	'Could' is the past of 'can' for permission.
35	**can't**	Short answer: No, you can't.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-B 2-A 3-E 4-C 5-D**	No smoking – You can't smoke here.; No photos – You can't take photos.; Free Wi-Fi – You can use the internet.; No entry – You can't go in.; Open to the public – You can come in. Signs show what is allowed or not allowed.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	Can I use your phone? – Yes, you can.; Can I park here? – No, you can't.; Could I open the window? – Yes, of course.; Could I sit here? – Sorry, it's taken. Reply to permission questions.
38	**1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A**	You can't wear jeans. – You couldn't wear jeans.; You can use phones. – You could use phones.; Students can't talk. – Students couldn't talk.; We can go out. – We could go out. can → could; can't → couldn't.
39	**1-B 2-E 3-D 4-A 5-C**	In a library – You can't talk loudly.; In a park – You can walk on the grass.; In a hospital – You can't smoke.; In a restaurant – You can ask for the menu.; In a museum – You can't touch the paintings. Rules use can and can't.
40	**1-E 2-C 3-D 4-A 5-B**	Where can I park? – Behind the building.; What can I eat here? – Anything on the menu.; When can we go home? – At five o'clock.; Who can I ask? – Ask the manager.; How can I pay? – By card or cash. Wh- word + can + subject + base verb.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**use**	After 'can I' we use the base form.
42	**park**	After 'can't' we use the base form.
43	**open**	After 'could I' we use the base form.
44	**wear**	After 'couldn't' we use the base form.
45	**go**	After 'can' we use the base form.
46	**play**	After 'can't' we use the base form.
47	**Can** (or: Could)	Permission questions start with 'Can' or 'Could'.
48	**couldn't**	'Yesterday' needs the past: couldn't.
49	**couldn't**	'In 1950' needs the past: couldn't.
50	**Can**	'Can' never takes -s.

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